

AI FOR QA TESTERS

AI Exploratory Testing Workbook

Generate sharper test ideas and charters with AI, then explore like a pro.

Introduction

Exploratory testing is creative, structured investigation. AI is a great idea-generator for charters, personas and "what if" scenarios — then you do the actual exploring and thinking.

Instructions

- Pick a feature and a time-box (e.g. 45 minutes).
- Use AI to brainstorm charters, risks and edge ideas.
- Explore against the real product; take session notes.
- Log findings and new questions; feed surprises back into more charters.

Worked Example (idea prompt)

"Suggest 10 exploratory testing charters for a password reset feature, covering security, usability, error handling and edge cases. For each, give a one-line mission."

Blank Charter Template

- Charter / mission:
- Time-box:
- Areas / risks to explore:
- Test data / personas:
- Observations:
- Bugs found:
- New questions / follow-up charters:

Heuristics to Prompt With

Lens	Prompt idea
Boundaries	What happens at min/max/empty/huge inputs?

Lens	Prompt idea
Interruptions	What if I refresh, go back, or lose connection mid-flow?
Personas	How would a careless / hostile / first-time user behave?
Data	What unusual but valid data could break assumptions?

Practical Exercise

Generate 10 charters for a feature you can access, run two 30-minute sessions, and record findings plus three follow-up charters the exploration revealed.

Best Practices

- Use AI to widen ideas, not to replace your investigation.
- Time-box and take notes as you go.
- Let real findings drive the next charter.

Common Mistakes

- Treating AI charters as a script to click through.
- No note-taking, so findings are lost.
- Stopping at the happy path.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

AI gives you more doors to try; exploratory skill is knowing which to open and what you notice once inside. Stay curious and follow the surprises.